down and the four metal wheels at each corner that pointed toward the sky.

"The carts!" Paulette shouted, jumping with excitement.

"I don't think you can fit inside one now." Virginie laughed.

Rose came forward and pulled one out, flipping it around. Léa peered inside the hollow interior. It was just big enough to hold a couple of demijohns, maybe four, if they were stacked close and one on top of another. "How many carts are here?" she asked.

Paulette helped her count. "Eight, nine, ten," the girl said, a zing of pride ringing in her voice.

Virginie turned to Paulette. "Why don't we go back to the house and get the dinner ready while Rose and Léa sort through these carts?"

Rose turned to Léa. "How will these carts help us?"

"The wheels," Léa said. "See how straight they are? They're designed to run on tracks, not on regular ground."

"So?"

"There must be tracks in the tunnel."

"Was that Édouard's message?"

"I think so. He wants us to transport the wine through the tunnel."

"By using these rail carts?"

"If we can put all the demijohns in and make one trip, it will save a lot of time."

"Let's go back to the *chai* and check the tunnel to see if there are rails."

"I'm worried about Monsieur Ferney," Léa said, looking around.

"You think he's watching?"

"I think Weinführer Brucker sent him to watch us. Let's wait until later tonight, after everyone has gone to sleep. Then we can sneak into the *chai* and keep the lights off."

"But it will be too dark to come back here to bring the carts around. I say we move them now while there's still some light. We can stack them in the courtyard close to the *chai*."

"Good idea."